



INDIA'S FIRST LOK ADALAT & LEGAL AWARENESS CAMP FOR NATIONAL RURAL EMPLOYMENT GUARANTEE ACT & SCHEMES (NREGA & NREGS) WAS ORGANISED BY JHARKHAND STATE LEGAL SERVICES AUTHORITY (JHALSA).

Jharkhand State Legal Services Authority (JHALSA) became the first Legal Services Authority of the country to ensure "Access to Justice" to the poor and the needy by organizing a Workshop-cum-Lok Adalat on NREGA (National Rural Employment Guarantee Act) successfully, in Naxal affected District Latehar (Jharkhand) on 7th of February, 2009.

A National Seminar on "Interaction on implementation of National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme" on the occasion of Gandhi Jayanti (2nd of Oct., 2008) was organized by National Legal Services Authority (NALSA). The Hon'ble Prime Minister of India, Dr Manmohan Singh, inaugurated the seminar which was presided over by Hon'ble Mr Justice K.G. Balakrishnan, Chief Justice of India and Patron-in-Chief, NALSA.

Hon'ble Mr. Justice Arijit Pasayat, Judge, Supreme Court of India and Executive Chairman, NALSA, conducted the seminar including an open interaction with Executive Chairmen and Member Secretaries of State Legal Services Authorities, Chairmen and Secretaries of High Court Legal Services Committee, Ministers, Secretaries and various stake holders for creation of awareness about the scheme among the rural people.

Hon'ble Mr. Justice M.Y. Eqbal, Executive Chairman of Jharkhand State Legal Services Authority, represented his department in the seminar and explained the idea mooted in the seminar by holding a formal workshop-cum-Lok Adalat in Latehar district of Jharkhand under the patronage of Hon'ble Mrs. Justice Gyan Sudha Misra, Chief Justice, Jharkhand High Court & Patron-in-Chief, JHALSA.

The objective of the Workshop-cum-Lok Adalat for NREGS at Latehar was to generate awareness through Legal Literacy and to organize Lok Adalats as a continuous forum to redress grievances, arising out of NREGA, of rural workers who are guaranteed employment under NREGS.

For the rural poor workers it is a tedious job to resolve legal problems under NREGS through a regular court and a Lok Adalat is an Alternative Dispute Resolution mechanism (ADR) that offers them a speedy and cheaper way to gain justice effectively and efficiently.